to send tremors of terror to India and Indians.

2. *Psychological Impact and Fear:* Along with the use of violence, the terrorists aim at breaking the morale of the people by raising insecurity in their minds. With the severity of the attacks the terrorists try to create massive psychological impact and fear in the minds of the people. The objective is to shock and awe large audiences with acts of terror. Terrorists also attack national symbols to show their power and to shake the foundation of the country or society they are opposed to. This may sometimes negatively affect a government's legitimacy, while increasing the legitimacy of the given terrorist organization and or ideology behind a terrorist act. The Mumbai siege and attack on the Taj are pointers in this direction. The attack on the World Trade Center was a direct assault to American national pride.

3. *Perpetration for a Political Goal:* Most often terrorist attacks have, as their goal, the achievement of a political purpose. Terrorism then becomes a political tactic. The perpetration of terrorist acts is often directed in giving shocks to the government so that the government succumbs under its pressure.

4. *Deliberate Targeting of Non-Combatants:* The choice of targets also becomes important. Generally, terrorists aim soft targets like civilians. Most of the time, the victims of terrorism are targeted not because they are threats, but because their suffering accomplishes the terrorists' goals of instilling fear, sending a message out to the world, to the specific government, specific community or just trying to accomplish their political ends indirectly.

5. *Use of Disguise:* Terrorists almost invariably pretend to be non-combatants, hide among non-combatants, fight from in the midst of non-combatants. This was seen during the Mumbai siege of 26/11/2008.

6. *Unlawfulness or Illegitimacy:* Though some official definitions try to characterize terrorist activities on the basis of illegitimacy or unlawfulness, there is an inherent difficulty in this. The use of the criteria on terrorism becomes problematic when one considers the cases of state-sponsored terrorism.